

Problem 5: Maldivian

(18 marks)

Below are four lines of a poem written in the Maldivian¹⁰ language, using the Thaana writing system. The Latin transcriptions in scrambled order are given on the right.¹¹

Some words are missing from the Latin transcriptions and have been replaced by placeholders such as [1], [2], etc.

A. ޅަނަ ބަގަ ރަވަ ރަވަ ރަވަ

i. ekam [1] avaha eythi geleyne

B. ޅަނަ ރަވަ ރަވަ ރަވަ ރަވަ

ii. [2] mage [3] reethi lhen

C. ރަވަ ރަވަ ރަވަ ރަވަ ރަވަ

iii. moonu balaa loagadun [4] soora

D. ރަވަ ރަވަ ރަވަ ރަވަ ރަވަ

iv. thi [5] enme fahu loabi

Assignment 1: (4 marks)

Determine the correct correspondences between lines (A-D) written in Thaana and the transcriptions (i-iv).

Assignment 2: (2 marks)

One of the words in Maldivian is written in an unexpected way. What is this word? Explain your answer.

Assignment 3: (5 marks)

Fill in the blanks [1] to [5].

Assignment 4: (3 marks)

Write the following names of islands in Thaana:

¹⁰Maldivian (also known as Dhivehi) is an Indic language spoken by approximately 350,000 people in the Maldives, and is the official language.

¹¹lh and th are consonants.

- (a) finey
- (b) baarah
- (c) angaagau

Assignment 5: (4 marks)

Explain how the Thaana writing system works. You do not need to list the meaning of every symbol.

– Vlad A. Neacșu
